VICTORY 2026

HISTORY

Rise of Dictatorship

Lecture 02

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Topics *to be covered*

1. Fascism
2. Nazism



Which of the following was NOT a cause of Fascism in Italy?

1. Economic stability
2. Class conflicts
3. Leadership provided by Mussolini
4. Threat of Socialism or Communism



Fascism in Italy

- Italy was ruled by King Victor Emmanuel during the First World War.
- He was a weak ruler and lagged in the Industrial Revolution and in the race for colonial possessions.
- Benito Mussolini was a socialist in the beginning. When he realised that as a socialist, he could not get any finances from the industrialists, he became anti-socialist.
- He formed different groups known as "Fascios" who organised violence against the socialists and the communists.

Socialists To Benito Mussolini





Fascism in Italy

- Later, these groups were organised into the Fascist Party.
- A conference of the members of the Fascist Party was held at Naples in October 1922.
- Mussolini announced that if his demands are not met, he would attack Rome.

Demands Of Benito Mussolini

- Five members of the Fascist party should be included in the Cabinet.
- New elections should be announced.
- The government should act firmly on its foreign policy.
- Economic reforms should be implemented at the earliest.



Benito Mussolini

- These demands were not accepted by the government.
- Mussolini marched to Rome with his followers on 28 October 1922.
- Emperor Victor Emmanuel III invited Mussolini to form a new government.

Benito Mussolini

- After taking over power, Mussolini appointed Fascists as prefects in the Provinces. He also organised the National Army.

Which of the following did not contribute to the rise of Fascism?

1. Treaty of Versailles
2. Rise of democracy
3. Economic crisis
4. Fear of Communism

- The takeover of the government by Fascists was followed by the reign of terror and within a short span of time, Mussolini became the absolute master of Italy.
- Power to Mussolini was handed over to Mussolini because the ruling classes of Italy considered democracy and socialism as threats to their power.

- Mussolini believed, “Italy must expand or perish”.
- He captured several territories. He conquered Abyssinia in 1936. When the League objected, Italy left the League of Nations.
- Fascism in Italy ended after the end of the Second World War. Mussolini was removed from power by his own party council in 1943. He was executed in 1945. Thus, fascism came to an end in Italy.



Impact of Fascism

Positive impact of Fascist Rule:

- Mussolini did several administrative and economic reforms to strengthen Italy. He took measures to stop the devaluation of the currency. He expanded agriculture and set up many hydroelectric power plants to overcome the shortage of coal.
- He took several steps to reduce unemployment. Factories and mills were nationalised and syndicates were established to improve relations between the capitalists and the workers. He also improved the transport system in Italy.



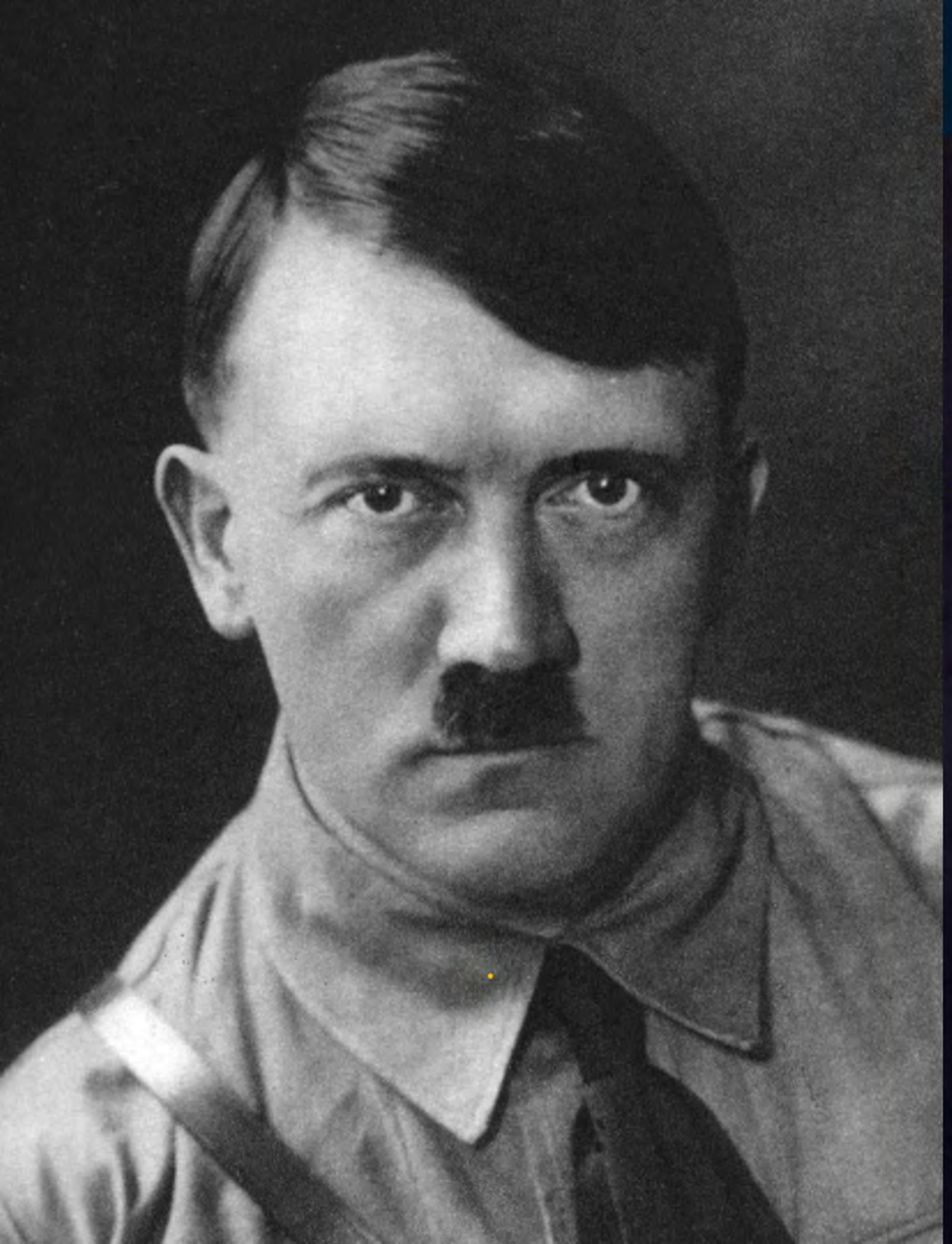
Impact of Fascism

- Many new schools, colleges and libraries were set up to remove illiteracy.
- Measures were taken to increase the military power of the country.
- Military training was made compulsory and efforts were taken to improve the naval powers of Italy.
- A pact was signed between Mussolini and the pope.
- The pope agreed to take a subordinate position and recognise the government formed by Mussolini. **Mussolini recognised Roman Catholicism as the state religion.**



Negative impact of Fascist Rule:

- All political freedoms of the people were taken away
- Italy became a dictatorial state, and all civil and military powers were in Mussolini's hands.
- All political parties except the Fascists were banned.
- Press was censored and freedom of speech was denied to the people.
- Mussolini crushed all his opponents.



Dekh Kya Raha Hai Vro ?

Hitler Hu...



Nazi Dictatorship in Germany

- After the defeat of Germany in the First World War, King Kaiser Wilhelm was forced to leave the throne. Free and fair elections were held to the Parliament.
- The government was formed and a new Constitution was adopted, and Germany became a democratic republic. But , no single party was able to secure majority in the elections.
- Between 1919 and 1933, 21 ministries headed by 12 Chancellors were formed.
- The economic condition of the country was bad , and there were riots and attempts were made to capture power.



Hitler's Rise to Power and Fall

- Adolf Hitler was an Austrian by birth and had fought for Germany in the First World War.
- In 1919, he joined a small party—**The German Workers Party—which later changed its name to the National Socialist Party or the Nazi party. Hitler became the leader of the party.**
- He had planned to capture power by marching through Berlin.
- He was however arrested and jailed. It was during this period that he wrote Mein Kampf.

- After his release, he contested elections in July 1932, but failed to get a majority in the Reichstag (German Parliament).
- When the government formed under Von Papen could not function for long, President Hindenburg invited Hitler to form the government.
- After the death of Hindenburg, Hitler assumed all powers and adopted the title of **"Fuhrer".** He abolished the Constitution, and Germany became a dictatorial nation.
- In the Second World War, Hitler was defeated by the Allied powers. He committed suicide in 1945.

Hitler planned to capture power through a march on ..... .

1. Berlin
2. Reichstag
3. Munich
4. Rome



Causes Leading to the Rise of Nazism

Humiliating Treaty of Versailles

- Germany was defeated in the First World War and was forced to sign the humiliating Treaty of Versailles.
- Several harsh terms were imposed on Germany by the victorious nations. Its overseas colonies were seized by the Allied powers, he had to pay a huge war indemnity of 33 billion dollars, the Rhine area was demilitarised and many of his mineral territories were captured.
- Hitler openly defied the treaty and asked the Germans to support him into building a new powerful Germany



Growing Fear of Communism

- The communists had organised themselves in Germany, and they had succeeded in capturing many seats in the Reichstag.

- Hitler criticised the growing influence of communism and asked the Germans to vote for him as Nazis could alone check the rising tide of communism.



Economic Crisis

- The economic conditions of Germany deteriorated after her defeat in the First World War. Her industrial and agricultural production declined.
- Many countries raised tariffs on German manufactured goods and the number of unemployed youth increased.
- Hitler promised the people of economic restructuring and reorganization of German finances after forming the government.

Rise of Militant Nationalism

- Hitler assured the people that he would work to regain the lost glory of Germany and make Germany an all powerful nation. People thus began to support him.



Mitron Mujhe Vote Do

Mai Launga Ache Din



Anti-Semitic Propaganda

- Hitler carried on anti-Semitic propaganda.
- He said that the Jews had conspired with the Allies during the First World War and were responsible for the defeat of Germany.
- Because of his anti-Semitic propaganda, many Germans began to support him.



Charismatic Personality of Hitler

- Hitler had an attractive personality.
- He was an excellent orator; through his speeches, he made people believe that only he can work for the upliftment of Germany.
- He was a sharp politician. He assured the people that their economic problems would come to an end after the formation of the government by the Nazis.



New Style Of Politics

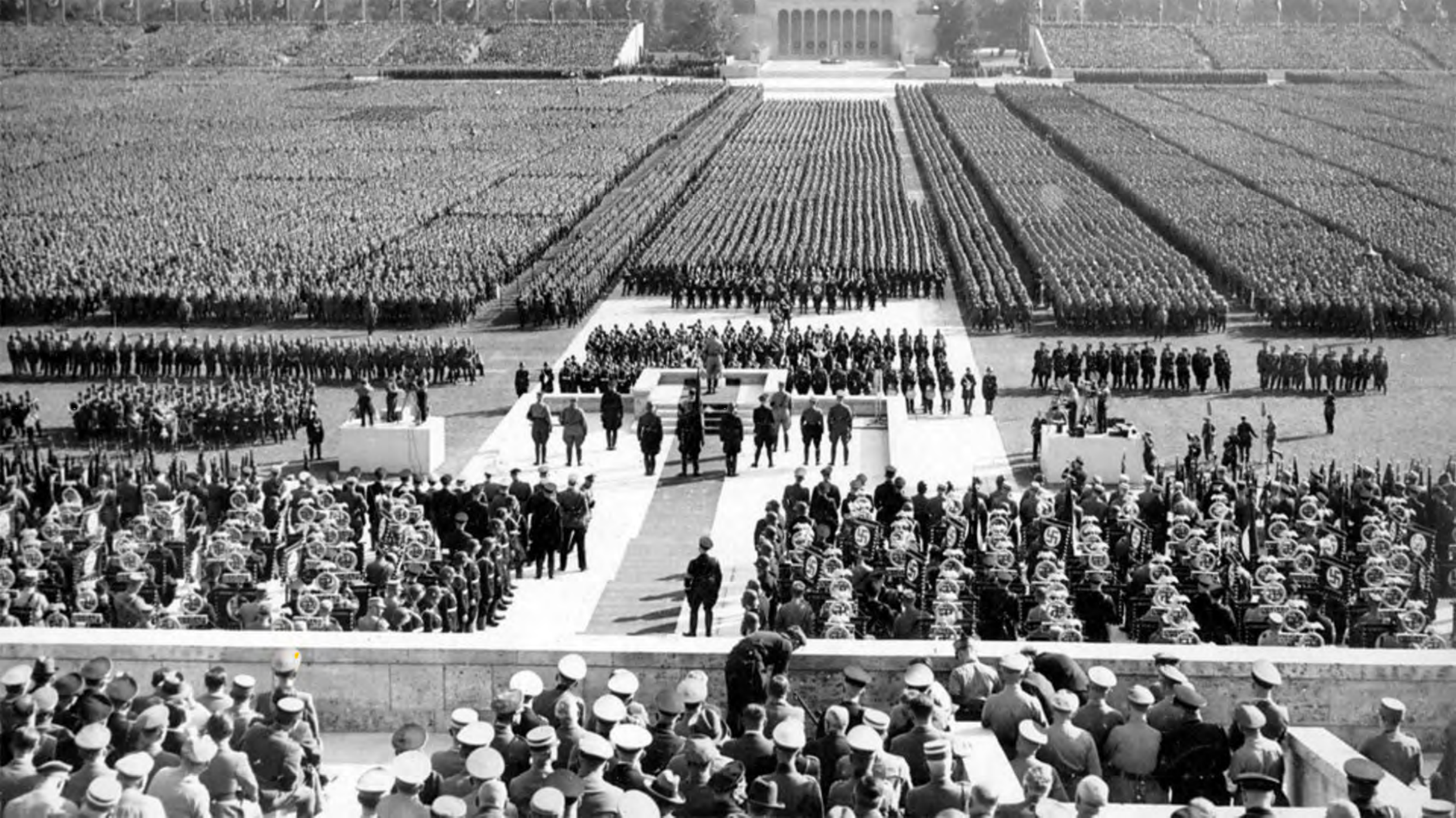
- He formed a new style of politics. Massive rallies and public meetings were held by the Nazis to display the strength of the party. Nazi propaganda also showed Hitler as a messiah who could bring out people from their problems. He captured the imagination of the German

Saviour

publicity



Hitler's excellent oratory skills won him the support of the people.





Absence of Strong Opposition

- There was an absence of a strong opposition party in Germany which could challenge the ideologies and plans of the Nazis.
- As the Nazis did not encounter any effective resistance, Hitler became extremely popular with the people.



Aims of Nazism

promote

- To acclaim nationalism
- To promote rule by a great leader from a single party
- Denounce internationalism, peace and democracy
  - To leave
- To use force and brutality
- Wars are necessary to increase the might of the country
- To uphold the racial supremacy of the Germans and ignite hatred for the Jews
  - only Nordic German Aryans → best
  - create

What was the main objective of Hitler's foreign policy?

hate / oppose

1. To despise internationalism, peace and democracy
2. To use force and brutality
3. To establish a Totalitarian state
4. To reject the Treaty of Versailles



Impact of Nazism

Establishment of a Dictatorial State

- Hitler established dictatorship in Germany. He had all powers in his hands and suppressed the opposition.

Single party nation

- He made Germany a unitary power from a federal power. All political parties except the Nazi and affiliated parties were declared illegal.

- A secret police known as „Gestapo" was established which kept a check on the citizens of Germany. Right to freedom of speech was denied to the people.



Economic Reforms

Several reforms were introduced by Hitler to reconstruct the economy of the nation. Some economic reforms which were undertaken by him were

- Industrial and agricultural production was encouraged and factories were set up to provide work to the people.
- A food cooperation was set up to control food production, its pricing and distribution.
- Capitalists → Businessmen were encouraged to increase production and strikes were banned.
- The production of heavy armaments, aeroplanes and naval ships was increased.
- Trade unions were dissolved. All workers were expected to work under the leadership of Hitler.



Militarism and Compulsory Military Training

- The size of the German army, air force and navy was increased.
- Military training was made compulsory for the citizens.



Renounced Peace Treaties

- One of the major objectives of the foreign policy of Hitler was to reject the Treaty of Versailles.
- He considered the treaty as unjust and openly condemned it.
- He refused to pay war reparation. He also increased the military power of Germany.

↳ Compensation



Acquisition of Territories

- Hitlers main aim was to acquire overseas colonies for Germany. He believed that colonies were necessary to settle expanding population of Germany and to get raw materials for industries.
- Hitler was keen on expanding in Southern and Eastern Europe as the region was rich in minerals and agricultural products.
- Hitler entered into a non-aggression treaty with Poland for a period of ten years in 1934 for safeguarding its eastern frontiers.
- He also recaptured Saar and Rhineland from France.
- He signed a non-aggression pact with Russia.



Racial Supremacy

- Hitler believed in the racial supremacy of the Aryans. According to the theory of racial supremacy, only the Nordic German Aryans were supreme in society. The Jews were placed in the lowest strata of society. The Jews were regarded as the fiercest enemies of the German Aryans.
- After assuming power, the Nazis sought to eliminate the Jews and the physically disabled Germans. Along with them, gypsies and black Germans were also detained in concentration camps.



Racial Supremacy

- The worst sufferers were the Jews.
- They were forced to live in miserable circumstances in the ghettoes. In the early years of Nazi rule, the Jews were forced to leave Germany. In the later years of Hitler's rule, the Jews were rounded up in concentration camps and gas chambers.
- The Polish were forced to leave their properties and home behind for the Germans who came to settle in Poland.
- Most of the Polish were put into concentration camps. Many of them were murdered in large numbers.

According to the leader whose picture is on the right who all had to be purged to ensure dominance of the master race?

1. Jews, communists and Christians
2. Communists, socialists
3. Germans, Italians and French
4. British, Americans and Indians





Similarity between the ideologies of Fascism and Nazism

- Both believed in the existence of a totalitarian state
- To oppose democracy and communism
- To uphold the concept of one party and one leader
- To believe in aggressive nationalism and imperialism
- To glorify war

Most Imp / Expected

One leader
One party
} Complete Control



Similarity between the ideologies of Fascism and Nazism

- Both Fascism in Italy and Nazism in Germany arose because of the poor economic conditions of these countries during this time.
- Both countries were not happy with the terms of the Treaty of Versailles and feared the possible spread of communism.
- Failure of the League of Nations and political instability also paved the way for the establishment of dictatorship in both countries.

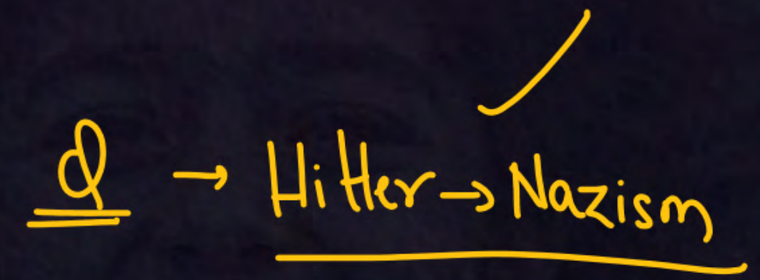


Homework From VICTORY Module

Oct – Dec ✓

1. Previous Chapters → Revision (Weekly Table) ✓
2. PYQ Practice → Last 5-6 yrs.
3. Priortise your Chapters




Hitler → Nazism


Thank You